Dear Amanda and Closure

By Steve Martin

DEAR AMANDA (Pg 26-29)

Dear Amanda,

This will be the last letter I write to you. I think we have made the right decision. Thank you for your love. We had a wonderful experience these past five months. I want you to know that our time together will live inside me in a special place in my heart. It is best if we do not phone or write.

Love always, Joey

INTRODUCTION

We've all been there. "What did I do wrong?" you ask yourself. "Was it something I said? Something I wore? My breath? How I kiss? You want reasons. You want answers. You want the truth. YOU CAN'T HANDLE THE TRUTH! Well, maybe you can, but why do you want it? To argue with her? To convince her she's wrong? How will you feel if she gives you a list of reasons she doesn't like you? You'll get your closure, but your self-esteem might take a hit. You'll also look desperate in the process.
Dear Amanda by Steve Martin

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Dear Amanda,

I dialed you last night because the *Lucy* pie episode was on and I knew you'd want to see it. Anyway, while I was leaving a message, I leaned on the phone and accidentally punched in your message-retrieval code. Sorry about that. Who's Francisco? Just curious.

Joey

Dear Amanda,

I realized that I still had your set of six Japanese sake cups that I bought for you on our trip downtown and was wondering when it might be a good time to drop them off. You can give me a call at the usual number but maybe better at the office up till seven but then try the car or I'm usually home now by seven forty-five. I would like to get these back to you, as I know you must be thinking about them. This will be my last letter.

Regards, Joey

Dear Amanda,

It was a lucky coincidence that my cat leapt on your speed-dial button last night, as it gave us a chance to talk again. Afterwards, I was wondering what you meant when you said, "It's over, Joey, get it into your head." So many interpretations. Just curious. Oh, I found myself on your street last night and noticed a yellow Mustang that I don't remember ever being at your apartment complex. Is this the mysterious Francisco I've heard rumors about? No big deal. Just curious. I left one of the sake cups at your front door; it happened to be in my car. What was that loud music?

With respect, Joey

Dear Amanda,

This will be the last letter I write to you. I hate to hurt you like this, but I'm seeing someone new. You'd like her. Her name is Marisa-she has the same number of letters in her name as you! Incidentally, I heard that Francisco had or is having a tax problem. Should I meet with him? I'm over it all now and would be glad to help.

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Also, a word of warning: Latins. One woman is never enough. Just a thought.

Joey

P.S. Do you have my red Pentel pen? I really need it. *Text* me when you get this.

Dear Amanda,

This will be the last letter I write to you. I'm quite upset that you changed your phone without a forwarding number. There could still be emergencies, and I'm still in possession of those fancy upholstered hangers of yours. Marisa questioned me about them the other day, and it wasn't fun. They're probably too dear to you to throw out, as we bought them together at the swap meet the day your mother raved about me, saying I was "pleasant." *Please* come by and pick them up; they're seriously damaging my relationship with Marisa. A good time would be any Wednesday after five but not after seven, Fridays anytime except lunch, Monday is good, and the weekend, anytime. Also Tuesday. By the way, there's someone named Francisco trying to pick up girls

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on the Internet. Hmm . . . I wonder.

Joey

Dear Amanda,

Valentine's Day is tomorrow, and I hope you don't mind my throwing this note through your window, as the post would be too slow. The rock it's tied to came from our desert trip! I'm wondering if you'd like to get together for a quick lunch on the fourteenth -- you can even bring Francisco if you want; maybe I could help him sort out his heavy urology bills. I need to get my letters back from you, and could you bring this one too? I could bring the hangers, and I also want you to have the photo of me nude skydiving. Can you let me know soon? I'm waiting outside on the lawn. This will be the last letter I write to you.

Love you always, Joey

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TRANSITION

CLOSURE: The ending of a piece of one's life. Closure means finality; a letting go of what once was. Finding closure implies a complete acceptance of what has happened and moving on to something new. Obviously Joey had problems finding closure with Amanda. But the rest of his life could have been fine . . . except for one thing. He became obsessed with CLOSURE by Steve Martin.

CLOSURE (Pg 106-108)

Closure. I wanted it. Or I wasn't going to be able to move on.

The taxi had dropped me off fully ten blocks earlier than I had requested. Sixty-first instead of Seventy-first. Luckily, I had copied down the cab number in case for some reason I needed closure. This time I did. I called the taxi company from my cell phone. I told them what I wanted. "Some kind of closure," I said. "I need to get on with my life." They understood. Thus the day had begun.

[Then] it was a little matter of a short-change

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at the supermarket. One dollar and fifty cents. Not much, but as I stood there counting the change, realizing the mistake, I couldn't move on. I confronted the check-out girl.

"Oops," she said.

Oops? Oops? This was not closure. How was I to move on? I did not sense that the store was taking responsibility. The manager came over and took me aside. He understood closure. He apologized, and took responsibility. I was lucky. I could move on.

My [new] girlfriend Josie was already at the apartment. I had given her a key just two weeks earlier. I came in with the groceries. We put them away and ordered in. We watched the news. Murder, larceny, confidence games: so many people who couldn't move on. I kissed her and held her hand. I took her to the bedroom. I tried *you know*, but couldn't. Too many loose ends. But she wanted closure. I explained that because so many people in my life weren't taking responsibility, it became impossible for me to accept my own responsibility.

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She understood. But she still wanted closure.

Two days go by. My movie theater free admission coupon is not being honored. A line forms behind me as I explain my situation to the ticket seller. I had called ahead to make sure it would be honored. They said it would be. Yet here I am, being embarrassed in front of strangers. Josie says, "Let's pay," and suggests that we move on. I cannot. I tell them I will need closure. The man selling tickets says the coupon people made a mistake, and they are the ones who will need to take responsibility.

"So you need closure," I say.

"Yes," he replies, "before we can move on."

"So my closure is dependent on your closure," I say.

"Yes."

Just then Josie says, "I need closure too, ***tonight***." She pays. I move on, even though I am unable to move on.

We watch the movie. It is about Mary Queen of Scots. She was beheaded. At least she got closure.

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When the movie is over, it says, "The end." We can go home.

"Pop" goes the champagne cork. Josie starts drinking. I start to worry. She starts kissing me. I am helpless. I can't move on. The phone rings and the machine picks up. It's the manager of the movie theater.

"I talked with the coupon people," he says, "they will issue a new coupon. I'm hoping now we can move on."

I smile at Josie. But something's still not right. I notice the answering machine blinking. I irritate Josie when I play back the message. It is the taxi company with a full apology. I can move on.

I give Josie closure. She snuggles next to me. A candle burns to the end and snuffs itself out. The moonlight trickles into the bedroom. I look at the bedroom door. It's ajar. I know what I need. [*(whispers)* C.L.O.S.U.R.E]

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SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

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